

Project Documentation

Project Overview:

This project was intended to provide a simple, modern website for a small landscaping company owned and operated by a someone known to me. The idea was to provide basic site that gives them an online presence in order to increase their legitimacy. The project accomplishes exactly that, although there were some minor changes to the original proposal.

Initially, my plan was to implement a “mobile first” design methodology. Instead, I built the site based on the Figma wireframe I made initially. This resulted in the desktop version being built first, and then the rest of the site being scaled down for tablet and mobile after. If I were to do this over again, I would make sure I followed the mobile first design.

The timeline was also not exactly realistic, since it did not account for all the other coursework that needed to be completed concurrently. I ended up starting by laying out the basic HTML and creating the wireframe in the first week as planned. After that, the CSS and JS were mostly finished in the last week. It worked this way because it was easier to build one page at a time, rather than each individual design component (HTML, CSS, then JS).

Target Audience:

The target audience for this project is anyone who owns property that is in need of landscaping services. This website addresses their needs by providing a connection to a local landscaping company. It lists out the services provided by the company, showcases their current work, provides a way to contact the company.

Core Features:

1. A navbar that is consistent across all pages with the company logo and title.
2. The homepage shows a thematic banner image with come general information about the company.
3. The gallery has several images showcasing the company’s work so far.
4. The contact page includes a phone number and the service area of the company.
5. A quote button that opens a modal with a form for the customer to request a quote.

Design an UX:

The design of the website used colors consistent with urban landscaping. It has green for grass, gray for concrete, and a white background for visual accessibility. Each key component of the website is organized in a card style format. Contacting the company is interactive. The phone card is clickable and will dial the company phone number, and there is a submittable form to request a quote.

Challenges:

The main challenge for this project was finishing all the desired features in the short amount of time. Although we had several weeks to build the side, the scope of my project is larger than I could comfortably fit. I also experienced a bit of scope creep, where I started adding a couple features that were not in the original proposal (quote modal and service area map API call).

The time I spent learning how to integrate the map API into my site and have it fit perfectly inside the little container took up more time than I would have liked due to the research necessary. Same with the modal for the form. I felt this was important though because I wanted at least one or two dynamic features on the site.

Lessons Learned:

With this being my first official “real world” project, I feel somewhat bitter sweet about how it turned out. It’s a functional site that accomplishes what I set out to do. But I feel like it’s mostly static and the dynamic features are a bit lacking. Next time, I’d like to include more dynamic features when considering plans for future projects. I have a lot of ideas on how to make this site more dynamic already.

The lesson here is, more consideration and planning on the front end will help avoid problems and last minute changes during development.

Future Improvements:

1. On the gallery page, make the images clickable so it opens a larger popup in the center of the page.
2. On the services page, make the services selectable so the customer can choose what they want to include in their quote, almost like a cart system.
3. The navbar feels a bit basic. I'd like to rework it to look more modern and stylish
 - a. The mobile navbar should turn into an expandable menu rather than links at the top.
4. The images on the gallery page also need to be optimized. The small thumbnail images load the full sized image (2-5mb each). It's extremely slow and consumes too much bandwidth for a simple page.
 - a. I need to create thumbnail images and swap these out for small files.